Jamilet Yalan Mendez

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PROFILE

UX researcher with 8 years across fintech, healthcare and education in Latin America and the UK, combining qualitative depth with quantitative rigour to influence product strategy in complex, fast-moving environments. Track record designing and running end-to-end studies, from large-scale qualitative interview programmes to concept testing and Wizard-of-Oz simulations, and translating findings into narratives and measurement frameworks that shift decisions across product, engineering, policy and business teams. Experienced leading international and cross-cultural research across Latin America, Brazil, the US and the UK, including regulated and trust-sensitive domains such as financial services and healthcare. AI-native in research workflows, using AI daily to synthesise data and scale insights, with hands-on experience turning research into working prototypes.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Service Designer | Royal London

May 2025 - March 2026

- Led end-to-end discovery for two programmes, running 23 qualitative research sessions with financially and emotionally vulnerable customers, advisers and customer service staff to define user needs, identify systemic gaps and shape design strategy.
- Synthesised research into 16 actionable insights, reframing the problem statement for both programmes and directly influencing design strategy and product direction.
- Designed and tested sacrificial concepts across five iterative rounds with 24 participants, using prototypes as conversation artefacts to surface user needs and validate direction.
- Produced end-to-end journey maps and a communications blueprint across advised and direct-to-consumer channels, partnering with UX, legal and marketing to incorporate accessibility and compliance requirements.
- Facilitated co-design sessions and cross-functional workshops with underwriting, claims, customer service and product teams to align on decisions and build shared ownership of improvements.

Methods: qualitative research, mixed-methods synthesis, iterative prototyping, usability testing, cross-functional facilitation.

Senior UX Designer | Globant Peru

Oct 2021 - Nov 2023

- Facilitated 20+ cross-cultural co-design workshops spanning four countries (US, Brazil, Chile, Peru) to align diverse stakeholder groups on service vision and implementation priorities.
- Designed a student onboarding service for Laureate Universities, reducing dropout rates through journey mapping and co-designed interventions with academic and administrative stakeholders.
- Led end-to-end design for multinational clients including Autodesk USA, Hospital Albert Einstein (Brazil) and BCI Bank Chile, managing competing stakeholder priorities across technical and business teams.
- Mentored junior designers in research and service design methodologies, establishing shared documentation standards across four product teams.

Workshop Facilitator | Repensar

May 2021 - Dec 2024

- Designed and delivered a Service Design curriculum training 100+ designers across Latin America in service design methodologies, systems thinking and co-creation techniques, achieving 95% student satisfaction.

Senior UX Designer | Crehana

Mar 2021 - Oct 2021

- Reframed a business assumption about course “discoverability”: stakeholders held quantitative data showing cancelling users cited being unable to find the right course, and had briefed the fix as a search problem.
- Ran 24 qualitative interviews across seven user segments and found the real issue was a content gap, users were running out of relevant courses beyond introductory level, not failing to find them.
- Presented user video clips in a stakeholder session to make the pattern visible across segments, shifting the team from a search fix to a strategy for advanced content and clearer learning paths.
- Established the UX practice from scratch as the first UX designer in the B2C division, defining ways of working, ceremonies and deliverable frameworks.

Product and Service Designer | Farmacias Peruanas

Jan 2020 - Feb 2021

- Designed and shipped a multi-product operations platform suite under pandemic conditions, giving a team of 20 real-time control over delivery capacity, store closures and order management across Lima's pharmacy network.
- Built the group's first cross-product design system from scratch, delivering consistent components across all platform modules within a one-month sprint.

UX Designer | Interbank

Sep 2017 - Jan 2020

- Promoted from UX Trainee to UX Designer after eight months, taking on end-to-end ownership of Interbank's main banking app roadmap.
- Served as lead designer for Interbank's main banking app for two years, owning the design roadmap one sprint ahead of development and conducting field research to inform iterative improvements.
- Ran mixed-methods concept testing for Frilea, an unbanked-freelancer product proposed by the CEO: tested three concepts via Facebook ads, using click-through rates alongside qualitative follow-up conversations to identify the strongest concept and validate real demand.
- Ran a Wizard-of-Oz test over WhatsApp to resolve which client segment (individuals, large companies, SMEs or independent entrepreneurs) should anchor the product, manually operating the full service end-to-end before writing any code, unblocking a decision the team had been stuck on for weeks.
- Redesigned the commercial section of the app promoting financial products; Extracash, a short-term lending product, saw approximately 40-50% growth in adoption following implementation.
- Led UX design for Plin in collaboration with BBVA and Scotiabank designers, facilitating co-design workshops to align three competing institutions around a shared user-centred vision.
- Conducted a 2-day field research sprint with agricultural workers in La Libertad, reframing the problem from digital usability to physical access constraints and prototyping a cardless withdrawal solution using existing ATM infrastructure.

Design Research Consultant | Rimac Seguros y Reaseguros (parallel consultancy)

Nov 2018 - Jan 2019

- Defined research strategy and operations to support a Behavioural Design initiative on health checkups, designing interview guides and research tools to uncover user needs and pain points.
- Identified user personas, motivators and behavioural triggers, analysing data to produce recommendations for the design team.

EDUCATION

MA Service Design | UAL London College of Communication

Oct 2023 - Dec 2024

- Major project: designed AfterCare+, a two-sided digital platform for NHS Pioneer Centre, producing fully interactive prototypes for a patient mobile app and a nurse tablet dashboard covering health data tracking, personalised care resources, direct messaging and clinical annotation tools, as well as developing a strategic roadmap using anticipatory innovation methods.
- Live projects with CIPD (career pathways service for young people) and DEFRA (sustainable farming framework for Net Zero 2050 using design futures methods).

BA Industrial Design | Pontifical Catholic University of Peru Mar 2011 - Jul 2017

- 4th year project selected for Global Grad Show at Dubai Design Week 2017. 5th year project awarded Critic's Award at PUCP Design Exhibition.

SKILLS AND TOOLS

Research and Testing: Qualitative interviews, concept testing, Wizard-of-Oz testing, service safaris, contextual inquiry, participatory design, usability testing, click-through/survey analysis, Maze, UserTesting, Dovetail

Mixed-Methods and Measurement: Quantitative concept testing, qual-quant synthesis, insight measurement frameworks, research operations, stakeholder narrative-building

Design and Prototyping: Figma, FigJam, Miro, Adobe XD, Sketch, Adobe Creative Suite

Product Design Methods: User flows, wireframing, interaction design, design systems, mobile and responsive design, accessibility, Double Diamond

Agile and Collaboration: Scrum, sprint planning, cross-functional facilitation, stakeholder management, Notion

AI and Emerging Tools: Daily use of AI in research and design workflows, synthesising qualitative data, delegating tasks to AI agents, and building working prototypes from research to code. Built and shipped a fully functional bilingual web app (HTML, CSS, JavaScript) with live deployment on GitHub Pages.

Languages: English (advanced), Spanish (native)

AWARDS AND RECOGNITION

- Selected Exhibitor | Global Grad Show, Dubai Design Week 2017
- 1st Place | Innovation Award, Interbank
- Critic's Award | PUCP Design Exhibition